

FROM SERVICE TO PRODUCT

Product management & product mindset for enterprise software service company

A bespoke training & transformation program · prepared for SoftServe · July 2026

I. CONTEXT

SoftServe is expanding beyond classic service delivery toward more repeatable IP and productized, value-based offerings: a response to shifting customer expectations and a way to strengthen its competitive edge. Accelerators, frameworks, reusable assets and services are expected to compound across engagements: some maturing into standalone products, some serving as technology enablers, some becoming productized services, each with a clear value proposition, lifecycle and adoption path.

The hard part of such a shift is rarely engineering. In services organizations, strong assets tend to be built for one client, owned by whoever built them, and funded only while a project pays for them. Making them repeatable raises questions a services company rarely has to ask: which problem and market does an offering serve beyond its first client? What makes it repeatable rather than re-buildable? Who owns its roadmap and adoption once the project ends? How do investment and incentives support work that isn't billable? The program is built around these questions and works them on SoftServe's own portfolio.

2. GOAL OF THE PROGRAM

Participants of the program are about 15 Softserve's service leaders, capability managers, architects, technical / product owners, delivery and engineering leaders. The program helps them:

- move from engineering / service thinking to product thinking;
- understand and manage the full lifecycle of products and reusable assets;
- define value propositions, run customer discovery, and drive adoption;
- shape repeatable offerings instead of one-off project delivery;
- bring AI / GenAI into everyday product-management work and service evolution;
- grow ownership and an outcome-based way of working.

The intended outcome is not frameworks memorized, but a changed default: leaders who reason about services, assets and initiatives as products, with customers, lifecycles and business models.

3. HOW SESSIONS WORK

All sessions are 2 hours, live online, in three complementary formats:

- **Interactive seminar:** theory and frameworks, the instructor's worked examples (from other industries and from services productization), and a discussion on applying the topic to the participants'

own products and services. Where a home assignment preceded the session, it also covers typical questions and good / bad examples from the submitted work.

- **Workshop:** a hands-on exercise on the participants' own products, in groups or all together, ending with a tangible outcome: a product-management artifact (a portfolio map, a Product Map, a packaging model, a roadmap) or a set of decisions, action items and ideas, presented and challenged by the instructor and the peers.
- **Home assignment (in groups):** between sessions, participants in groups of 3 or 4 applies the method to its product (2–3 hours per assignment; most assignments are cumulative): classic homework with the instructor's recorded feedback, or preparatory work feeding the next workshop.

4. THE PROGRAM AT A GLANCE

The program below is preliminary and will be adjusted to SoftServe's context after the discovery call and the information request are processed. The program may also evolve during the live course, based on the group dynamics and discovered insights.

Program includes 7 modules, 21 sessions: 12 interactive seminars (S) + 9 workshops (W). The detailed module-by-module program is in Addendum.

Module	Sessions	Format	Group home assignment (on the group's product)
1. Products in an enterprise services company	3	2 S + 1 W	Current-state one-pager + productization level
2. Product mindset	3	2 S + 1 W	Core insight + hypotheses
3. Product lifecycle: Define	7	4 S + 3 W	Product Map + 2 discovery interviews + validated hypothesis
4. Product lifecycle: Design & build	2	1 S + 1 W	Platformization split + packaging / pricing
5. Product lifecycle: Measure & manage	3	2 S + 1 W	Adoption metric system + Now / Next / Later roadmap
6. AI-powered product management	2	1 S + 1 W	Agentic PM setup sketch
7. Next steps	1	1 S	Capstone recap (live)
Total	21	12 S + 9 W	

5. DURATION & WORKLOAD

- **Intensive (recommended):** 2 sessions per week, ~11 weeks. Faster momentum, heavier weekly load.
- **Blended:** modules 1–2 at two sessions per week to build shared language, then weekly for the lifecycle modules, where discovery and validation need calendar time. Easier to protect in business calendars across locations; leaves room for real discovery / product work between sessions.

Total participant load is roughly 60–75 hours: 42 hours of live sessions plus home assignments and light workshop preparation.

6. INSTRUCTOR

Oleksii Orlov: seasoned B2B technology product leader with 14 years of experience in enterprise B2B SaaS, product innovation and expansion, and agentic AI.

- former SVP of Product at Creatio (enterprise B2B SaaS platform), former Chief Product Officer, Innovations at Jooble, currently Chief Product Officer at GigaCloud (cloud infrastructure) and fractional product leader, and advisor.
- Currently advising SoftServe's R&D unit on repeatable-IP strategy and productization processes.
- Product-management lecturer and corporate-program author for practicing product teams and technical leaders.

8. WHAT'S INCLUDED

The program includes:

- development of the tailored training program and all course materials (session decks + working templates, i.e. Product Map, hypotheses list, test / learning cards, roadmap templates, product ideas prioritization tables);
- delivery of all interactive seminars and workshops;
- unlimited access to all course materials together with video recordings of every session;
- review of group home assignments with the instructor's recorded feedback;
- a direct chat channel with the instructor throughout the program;
- a follow-up session ~4–6 weeks after the program to review progress on the transformation roadmap.

9. NEXT STEPS

To prepare the program (especially its workshops), two inputs are needed before the start:

1. **Discovery call.** A working session with the program sponsor(s) to explore needs, current situation and expectations, and to align group count, pacing and calendar.
2. **Information request.** A short brief on the products, services, accelerators and initiatives the participants work on right now: the input for workshops, home assignments and each group's working product.

With best regards,

Alex Orlov

ADDENDUM: DETAILED PROGRAM (PRELIMINARY)

All sessions – 1.5-2 hours (depending on the engagement level and questions). S = interactive seminar · W = workshop. Home assignments are done in groups of 3–4, each on the group's chosen product (~2–3 hours each).

Module	Topics	Workshops
1. Products in an enterprise services company 3 sessions · 2 S + 1 W 2 home assignments	– <u>The productization ladder</u>: packaged services → technology-enabled services (accelerators) → productized services → products → products-as-a-service; the economics and commitment of each level – <u>Product strategy in a services company</u>: where to play; the product-vs-feature decision (standalone offering vs. add-on to existing delivery) – <u>Productization case studies from B2B services</u>: what worked, what stalled, and why – <u>Productization artifacts & reusable assets</u>: what makes an asset genuinely reusable – <u>Organizational alignment</u>: people, investment allocation, incentives	Portfolio inspection & productization mapping Groups inventory the current services, accelerators and reusable assets; map them to company / unit goals; place each on the productization ladder and set a realistic target level. Each group confirms the working product it brings into the rest of the program.
2. Product mindset 3 sessions · 2 S + 1 W	– <u>Human-centered design</u>: start with the customer; problems and context before solutions – <u>Lean building</u>: validate before building; product-market fit before scale; MVP thinking – <u>Thinking in hypotheses</u>: desirability / viability / feasibility / usability risks – <u>Finding true problems</u>: “5 Whys”, jobs-to-be-done as a problem lens – <u>Strategic alignment</u>: aligning business goals, product goals and initiatives (impact mapping, OKRs)	From offer to hypotheses Groups take an existing idea for their product (a brief, a PRD, an accelerator concept), break it into hypotheses across the four risk lenses, and scope the smallest lean version that would test the riskiest assumptions.
3. Product lifecycle: Define 7 sessions · 4 S + 3 W	– <u>Define the market</u>: sizing (TAM / SAM / SOM), ideal customer profile, segmentation (core / situational / non-customers; early adopters) – <u>Define the problem</u>: what the customer is trying to achieve, why, and why they can't today; problem frequency & criticality – <u>Define the solution</u>: impact mapping (business goal → segments → behavior change → capabilities) – <u>Define alternatives, differentiation & positioning</u>: direct / indirect / adjacent competition; types of competitive advantage – <u>Define business model & outcomes</u>: business model, unit economics, business impact (acquisition / retention / monetization / profitability / strategic fit) – <u>Define GTM approach</u>: distribution channels, channels' pipelines, acquisition growth strategies – <u>Discover & validate</u>: customer-discovery methods (in-depth interviews, qualitative & quantitative methods, observation) and data analysis (product analytics, market research, segmentation, cohorts)	Product Map (2 parts) + discovery & validation planning Across three workshops, participants will collaboratively build the product map alongside related artifacts: audience, problem and customer value; then solution (impact map), alternatives / positioning and business value, presenting and taking challenge at each step. The third workshop turns the riskiest assumptions into a prioritized validation plan: hypotheses matched to methods, with success criteria. One of the workshops could be dedicated to running a live customer discovery interview and debriefing it afterwards.

	– <u>Prioritizing product ideas</u>: the qualitative method, RICE, the impact map	
4. Product lifecycle: Design & build 2 sessions · I S + I W	– <u>Product features</u>: co-design / co-development with customers; prioritizing features & scope (MVP approach, feature hamburger, RICE) – <u>The platformization spectrum</u> (custom <> fixed <> dev-configurable <> customer-configurable): the central productization decision for a services organization – <u>Product business model</u>: packaging & pricing (tiering, value metric, value-based pricing; monetization tests: Van Westendorp, max-difference); validating the model, packaging and pricing	Platformization & packaging For their product, groups split capabilities into the standardized reusable core vs. the bespoke customization layer along the platformization spectrum, then design a first packaging & pricing model (tiers, value metric, price anchor).
5. Product lifecycle: Measure & manage 3 sessions · 2 S + I W	– <u>The product feedback loop & measurement</u>: measuring activation, retention & engagement – <u>Processing qualitative customer feedback</u> (content-analysis matrix; AI-assisted classification) – <u>The pathway to enterprise adoption</u>: hand-holding, feedback sessions, data analysis, evals – <u>Metric systems</u>: value / outcome metrics (satisfaction, time-on-task, accuracy, conversion, activity); direct vs. proxy measures; cohorts vs. segments – <u>Planning</u>: prioritization frameworks; roadmapping (Now / Next / Later); stakeholder alignment	Adoption & roadmap workshop Groups define the adoption metric and a minimal metric system for their product, design its enterprise-adoption pathway, and build a Now / Next / Later roadmap with a stakeholder-alignment map.
6. AI-powered product management 2 sessions · I S + I W	– <u>Agentic AI to accelerate PM performance</u>: agents, skills and context systems in day-to-day product work, incl. a live demo of a working agentic-PM setup – <u>The PM role in the agentic-AI era</u>: the blurring boundaries between product, engineering and design – <u>Shipping AI solutions to customers</u>: evals & governance	AI-powered PM: focus areas Participants map proposed agentic AI use cases to their own work in areas like building PRDs, internal decks, market research, customer feedback triage, product analytics, etc., and define 1–2 focus areas where they will plan to apply
7. Next steps 1 session · I S	– <u>Turning engineering capabilities into repeatable offerings</u>: the product processes and operating model that make productization stick: recap + discussion on the next steps.	Transformation roadmap (facilitated brainstorm) A facilitated brainstorm on moving from single-project delivery to repeatable offerings: what to standardize, who owns which assets, which operating-model and incentive changes are needed. Participants commit to owned next actions; groups give a short capstone recap of their product's journey.